

The Dhāraṇī for Liberation from Bondage

Bandhamocanī-nāma-dhāraṇī · Toh 796 · Derge Kangyur

བཅདིས་པ་ལས་གཞོ་པའི་གཞུངས།

The Dhāraṇī for Liberation from Bondage (in Tibetan, Bcings pa las grol ba'i gzungs; the Sanskrit title is probably Bandhamocanī-dhāraṇī) is an extremely brief text, essentially a single short mantra paired with a statement of its benefit. It opens with homage to the noble Avalokiteśvara, the Sovereign Lord, and then gives the formula "tāre tāre tārāya, bhagavate, bandhamocani svāhā," promising that whoever recites this noble mantra will be set free from bondage. In the Buddhist tradition, such words of power are used to invoke the compassionate protection of a bodhisattva, here in the context of release from confinement and the binding constraints that afflict beings. The text is Toh 796 in the Kangyur, the Tibetan canon of translated Buddhist scripture, where it belongs to the class of tantra texts, which in this canon includes dhāraṇīs and mantras of this kind.

Homage to the Noble Avalokiteśvara, the Sovereign Lord.

Tāre tāre tārāya, bhagavate, bandhamocani svāhā.

If one recites this noble mantra, one is set free from bondage.

The dhāraṇī for liberation from bondage

Translator's Notes

- The passage breaks off at the start of what is evidently the title or opening of the dhāraṇī "Liberation from Bondage," so the final line is rendered as a fragment. The mantra is given as a transliteration of the Tibetan, with the Sanskrit rendered in standard form: bhagavate, bandhamocani, svāhā. The words tāre tāre tārāya are the vocative and verbal forms of the root "to carry across," meaning roughly "O Savioress, save, cause to cross." "Bandhamocani" means "she who releases from bonds." The Tibetan phrase translated "Sovereign Lord" (dbang phyug) corresponds to the īśvara element of the name Avalokiteśvara.

Colophon

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spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.